FROM STILLNESS TO STRENGTH

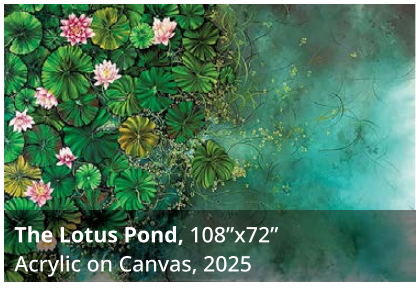
Meenu Goyal's Art and the Remaking of Modern India



Meenu Goyal

New Delhi based Artist

Born in 1974, New Delhi–based artist Meenu Goyal traces the beginnings of her artistic voice to a defining moment at 17, when meningitis left her with partial vision for more than a year. Stepping away from college and daily routine, she found herself drawn to the quiet rhythms of nature. Her mother's horticulture work meant the family garden became her sanctuary, where shifting light, gentle movements and subtle textures revealed a slower, more intuitive way of seeing.

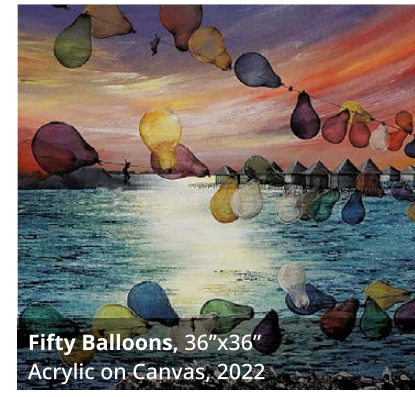


The Lotus Pond, 108"x72"
Acrylic on Canvas, 2025

With the ability to register only a few colours at a time, her early works naturally settled into restrained, meditative palettes. This challenge became a guiding force, teaching her to perceive through emotion rather than detail and shaping her enduring preference for muted tones, minimalism and a calm, uncluttered aesthetic. For Goyal, nature has always been both a sanctuary and a mentor. Its unhurried cycles - water gliding through the home fountain, a lotus unfurling, leaves shifting under a beam of afternoon light taught her patience, acceptance and the quiet beauty of gradual change.

As India itself transformed, from the modest, grounded landscape of her childhood to a country expressing its confidence more boldly, her colour language also expanded. Her later works explore stronger contrasts and richer tonal shifts, yet the spirit of serenity, introspection and quiet resilience remains the thread that binds her practice.

Goyal has seen global interest in Indian contemporary art grow steadily. Exhibitions at the American Center, Lalit Kala Akademi, India Habitat Centre, World Art Dubai, World Art Singapore and more have shown how warmly international audiences now embrace Indian narratives.



Fifty Balloons, 36"x36"
Acrylic on Canvas, 2022

Rooted and attuned to earthy elements, her art carries an ecological undertone with blues and greens serving as gentle reminders of balance, harmony and renewal. For Goyal, each painting is an act of gratitude— a way of rediscovering the world, and a reflection of India's own journey - grounded in its roots, confident in its voice, and always leaning towards the bright light of hope and positivity.

ARTIST ALKA PANDEY'S ABSTRACT LENS FOR INDIA'S EVOLVING CULTURAL SOUL

In the realm of abstract art, Alka Pandey's approach towards abstraction is not an escape, but a more profound way of looking and perceiving the world around. Her colour language is pure, unblended, and rooted in a philosophy that emotion should remain unfiltered, much like the pure hues in her creations. Her abstract practice is shaped by nature, Hindu thought, and deeply personal memories, yet it remains rooted in a single belief: purity matters.

She believes the natural world around her offers a complete palette — the monsoon greens, molten summer golds, and autumn's earthy browns. She blends colours in her artworks only when an emotion demands for it. Blue as a colour of peace, appearing only in the sky, softened at times with white or silver to lead viewers gently into her abstractions.



Belief by Alka Pandey



Archaic
36"X36"
Acrylic on canvas
Alka Pandey



Prosperous
30"X30"
Acrylic on canvas
Alka Pandey

Pandey is equally committed to making abstract art approachable. She adds concise notes beside her works, offering viewers an entry point into her symbolism. Spirituality runs quietly through her canvases: temples, mosques and churches surface not as structures but as sources of positive energy. Her guiding belief that the world is created without divisions of "mine" and "yours" — becomes a quiet manifesto for unity.

Among her notable works is "In My View – Benaras", a transformation of her earlier Abstract Benaras, rendered in brown and gold with a flowing orange stream. Another Benaras-inspired piece shows pilgrims walking away after a sacred dip, their turned backs symbolising renewal and the washing away of sins.



Alka Pandey

Mumbai based Artist

Having cleared two Maharashtra State Board art examinations and earned a degree from Sagar University, Pandey has been painting since the age of five — a practice she describes as "flowing in my bloodstream." Through her travels across Spain, Dubai, Paris, Chicago and Korea have deepened her conviction that art is a silent language that transcends borders and identities, echoing Tagore's belief that artists connect through creation.

In envisioning India's future, she imagines art as a unifying force — much like "a vibrant bouquet of flowers" positive in colour, spirit, and possibilities. Alka's vision stands as a reminder for India's culturally evolving soul. She believes the country's future will be shaped, not only by technology and progress, but by the colours, symbols and spiritual cohesion that have always defined its inner life.